



there. Now there's this business of belting the ball like England batters are doing and losing badly overseas.

Australia can be salvaged because the pitches there are beautiful to bat on after the first dozen overs or so, after which the ball hardly deviates off the surface. To do that, though, the team needs to play a bit more on those kinds of pitches. Instead, we are now told that the warm-up game before the first Test has been called off. Wouldn't it benefit youngsters like (Yashasvi) Jaiswal and Sarfaraz (Khan), who are playing on Australian pitches for the first time, to get some runs under their belt and get a feel of what the pitches will be like?

And if they get out early, they can still get into the nets and practice against the throwdown specialist or the net bowlers. For bowlers like Akash Deep and Harshit Rana too, it's essential to know the best length to bowl in Australia, as it's

Practice makes perfect: Sunil Gavaskar wants Team India to play some warm-up games, even if they are against State A teams like Queensland A and Victoria A. AP

different from India, and the best learning is in a proper match and not just net practice.

Let's just hope that good sense prevails, and even now, though it's too late, some warm-up games can be arranged, even if it's against the State A teams like Queensland A and Victoria A. These warm-up games will give the first-timers to Australia and the youngsters good practice and a better chance to succeed.

All Indian cricket fans are keeping our spirits high and our fingers crossed for Australia. Let's hope that the New Zealand series was just a bad dream and turns out to be a very good wake-up call.

With the balance that India has in its bowling attack, it's always a good idea to go in with a pitch that wears gradually rather than a pitch where the match finishes in about three days.